

The Dhāraṇī-Mantra of the Blessed One Amitābha

Bhagavān Amitābhadhāraṇīmantra · Toh 864 · Derge Kangyur

བཅའོ་ལ་ལྷ་འདས་སྐྱ་བ་མཐའ་ཡས་ཀྱི་བྱུངས་སྤྲས།

The Dhāraṇī-Mantra of the Blessed One Amitābha, known in Sanskrit as Bhagavān Amitābha Dhāraṇī Mantra, is a short ritual text centered on the buddha Amitābha, the buddha of boundless light. It opens with a homage to Amitābha, followed by a brief dhāraṇī whose epithets praise his limitless qualities and which ends with a petition for the destruction of all afflictions. The text goes on to describe the benefits of recitation: reciting it three times is said to exhaust the obscurations of karma accumulated over a hundred thousand eons, and reciting it twenty-one times purifies even the grave downfalls of the four roots and plants roots of virtue with a thousand buddhas. It is Toh 864 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of tantra-related texts, specifically the dhāraṇīs and mantras used in devotional and purificatory practice.

In the language of India: Bhagavān Amitābha Dhāraṇī Mantra. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī-Mantra of the Blessed One Amitābha.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha.

Tadyathā. Amite. Amitodbhave. Amitasaṃbhave. Amitavikrāntikare. Amitagaganakīrtikare sarvakleśakṣayaṃkari svāhā.

These are the benefits of this dhāraṇī. Even the obscurations of karma accumulated over a hundred thousand eons are exhausted if one recites it three times. If one recites it twenty-one times, even the downfalls of the four roots are completely purified, and one will have planted roots of virtue with a thousand buddhas. One should keep the Blessed One Amitābha in mind.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Mahāṃ duhike svāhā.

When the body is struck by illness, even if the illness has become a wasting disease within, recite this over a fan twenty-one times and fan the sick person with it, and they will become free of illness.

As soon as this dhāraṇī-mantra had been spoken, the entire assembly rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Here ends the Dhāraṇī of the Blessed One Amitābha.

Translator's Notes

- The "four roots" are the four root downfalls of monastic discipline, the pārājikas: sexual intercourse, taking what is not given, killing a human being, and falsely claiming spiritual attainments. The second mantra, "mahām duhike," is given as it appears in the Tibetan, and its Sanskrit form is uncertain. "Wasting disease within" renders nad khong skams, an internal disease that dries out or consumes the body. The fan is understood to be the object that the mantra is recited over.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.